

EXCEL COLUMN CHART

Compare values across categories

01

WHEN TO USE

- Data has **one category** and **one number** (e.g., Product + Sales).
- Answers: **Which category is highest or lowest?**
- Use it for **rankings** and quick comparisons of about 3-10 categories.

BUSINESS QUESTION

- Which product generated the highest sales?
- Which product is underperforming?
- How do the products rank against each other?

DATA EXAMPLE

	A	B
1	Product	Sales
2	Laptop	120,000
3	Monitor	85,000
4	Keyboard	45,000
5	Mouse	30,000

DATA ANALYST USE CASE

Example: Sales Analysis

QUESTION

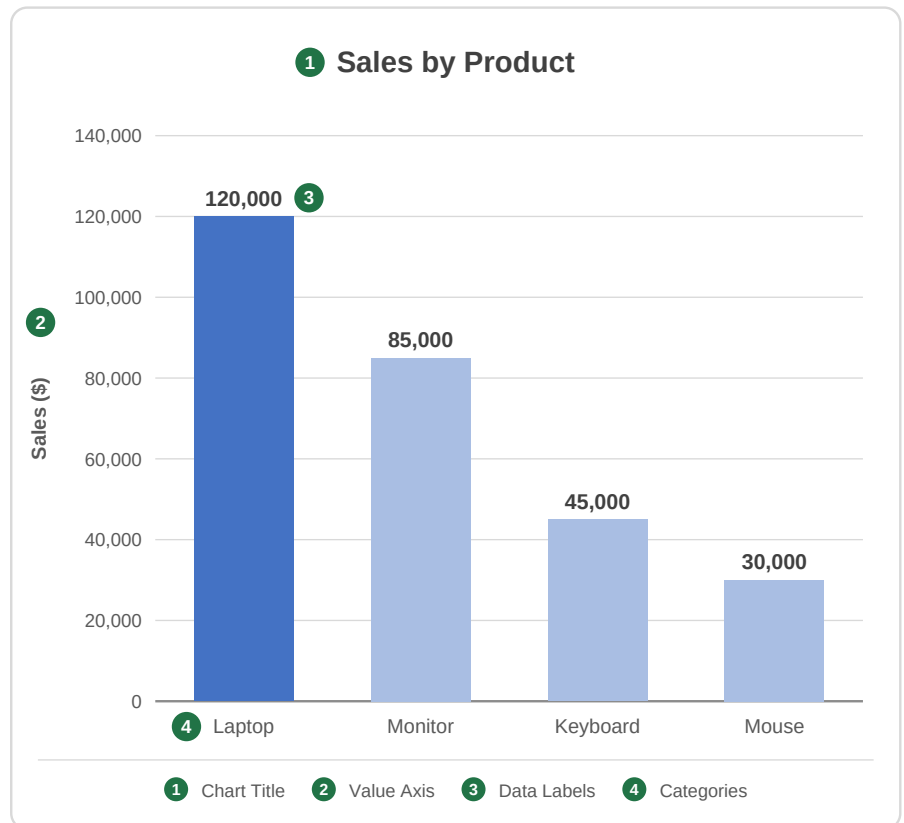
Which product sells the most?

CHART

Column Chart

INSIGHT

Laptop sales (120,000) are significantly higher than the other products, about 43% of all sales.



HOW TO CREATE IT IN EXCEL



- 1** Select the data, including the headers (A1:B5).
- 2** Go to the **Insert** tab and open the **Charts** group.
- 3** Click **Insert Column or Bar Chart** > **2-D Column** > **Clustered Column** (one series = a simple column chart).
- 4** Add a clear **Chart Title** (Chart Design > Add Chart Element > Chart Title).
- 5** **Format**: sort data largest to smallest, add Data Labels, use thousand separators.

DO / DON'T

DO ✓

- ✓ Use a clear, specific title
- ✓ Sort columns from largest to smallest
- ✓ Keep category labels short and readable
- ✓ Highlight the key column

DON'T ✗

- ✗ Use a vague title like "Chart 1"
- ✗ Leave categories in random order
- ✗ Overcrowd with 15+ columns
- ✗ Add 3-D effects or gradients



DATA ANALYST TIP

Use it when the goal is to compare categories.

Sort first, label clearly, and highlight the column that carries your message.